

LUCKNOW | Dubious Distinction



SANJAY SONKAR

Gandhi family loyalist T.V. Rajeshwar has left a string of controversies behind after departing as governor. Infamous for appointing vice-chancellors—most of who faced corruption charges, suspensions, dismissals and inquiries—Rajeshwar appointed Arvind Mishra as Officer on Special Duty (Legal) at Raj Bhavan just before his exit, a post that had been vacant for long. Many see this as his ploy to keep tabs on new Governor B.L. Joshi. The other appointment that is raising eyebrows is that of Dr Kripa Shankar as the vice-chancellor of Uttar Pradesh Technical University. The varsity is cash-rich with Rs 400 crore in its coffers; it also controls 500 engineering colleges in the state. Rajeshwar has also been accused of “saving Chief Minister Mayawati on several occasions” despite being a Congress appointee. Now it’s up to Joshi to clean up the mess.

by Subhash Mishra

KERALA | Cash Rap

A letter written to Ramesh Chennithala, Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee president, allegedly by Youth Congress State Secretary Thiruvallur Murali, has caused red faces in the Congress leadership. The missive provides details of Rs 1 crore each given to 17 party candidates by the AICC during the last Lok Sabha polls. Murali wrote the letter explaining the charges that he “kept” Rs 25 lakh from the funds. He claims that the money was stolen from him.

by M.G. Radhakrishnan

THE MINISTRY OF FINANCE AND THE RAJYA SABHA SECRETARIAT ARE FIGHTING OVER AIR MILES EARNED BY BABUS.

DELHI | Miles to Go

For nearly 10 months, two wings of the Government have been involved in a tussle over frequent flier miles earned by babus flying on official work. The Ministry of Finance feels such miles must be passed on to other government officials taking to the air, while the Rajya Sabha secretariat feels the miles are “allotted to individuals and not the organisation”. The exchange of the letters has been going on since October when the Finance Ministry issued a diktat that miles cannot be used for personal travel. by Shyamal Yadav

YEDDYURAPPA GOES THE HIGH-TECH WAY TO SECURE THE VIDHANA SOUDHA.

BANGALORE | Hard Lessons

People accompanying politicians to the “people’s palace” spell trouble for the police guarding the Vidhana Soudha. Sensing a security threat from such hangers-on, most of whom are without passes or identity proof, the Bangalore Police has now sought clearance for high-tech security checks for vehicles, pop-up tyre deflators, automatic boom barricades and vehicle scanner machines from the Government. In addition to the high-resolution CCTVs that can take pictures up to 3 km, the police want bunkers, more AK-47 toting personnel and bomb disposal squads. “Security is a big concern for us, which is why we have been asking the Centre to set up a National Security Guard unit in Bangalore,” said Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa. After 26/11, he isn’t taking any chances.

by Stephen David



SANJAY RAMACHANDRAN